

Sample Itinerary

We do not announce a day by day plan but set up the best plan to cover all sites in the area, avoiding crowded sites and taking weather condition and regulations into consideration.

1. Day

In the evening, starting from 18:00 H (6 PM) onwards transfer to New Marina (El Wataneya) port and embark. Welcome on board, cabin arrangement and boat briefing. Permission work with port authority, sailing very early next morning.

2. Day to 7. Day

Start with a check dive at nearby Temple or Ras Katy. Sail into the Gulf of Suez passing Yolanda Reef that is named after a 74 m long Cypriot freighter which struck the reef on the 1st of April 1980. The wreck laid partially submerged on the reef top until a storm caused it to drop. Most of the ship finally has fallen over the drop-off, leaving a huge scar in the slope between Shark and Yolanda Reef. Although, a quantity of the cargo remains for the amusement of the divers: bathtubs, toilets and bathroom fittings. Continue with the historical **wrecks of Dunraven**. Recovered in early 1970's, the more than 125 years old wreck is largely intact, totally covered in corals and rich in marine life.

The most famous of the Red Sea wrecks may be even worldwide is **the Thistlegorm**. The wreck first gained fame when Jacques Cousteau dived it in 1956 but left the actual location a mystery until it was rediscovered in 1992. Lying upright on the seabed at 33 m, the 127 m long and 18 m wide wreck is absolutely impressive. Close to Shaab Ali in the early hours of 22 February 1881, the 78 m long **Kingston** ran aground at the northern edge of the reef that is known as Shag Rock.

Crossing the Gulf of Suez will take you to Abu Nuhas, a paradise for wreck lovers which is best known for the abundance of ancient and modern wrecks that lie here: **Giannis D, Carnatic, Chrisoula K and Kimon M**. All are located on the northern side of the reef, a sandy seafloor at the bottom of a steep sloping coral reef filled with table corals. The reef is very exposed to the prevailing wind and waves and was named after the oldest wreck which was carrying copper (Nuhas in Arabic). Sailing over to Gubal Island and you find the little wreck of the Barge *). During the day the wide open wreck is covered in soft corals and fish life, at night it is entirely different and becomes an outstanding site. If weather permits you can dive the Ulysses or the Rosalie Moller. Only two days after the sinking of the Thistlegorm, the Rosalie Moller was also lying at anchor when hit and went down upright. The location outside of Gubal Island is extremely exposed to the sea, wind and waves. The dive is deep, bottom time is limited and visibility is lower than elsewhere so this dive is definitely only for very experienced divers.

**) Dive Sites in the area of Gubal Island may not be dived due to an order from the military. This affects the dive sites of Ulysses, Barge, Malak and the Rosalie Moller. It is unknown how long the restriction will be in place.*

In between wreck dives you will also visit some outstanding reefs at Shaab Mahmoud and Ras Mohamed National Park.

7. Day evening / 8. Day early morning

The last night will be spent at or close to port on board the liveaboard. Depending on the itinerary and/or administrative conditions, on week long safaris the last night might be arranged in hotel. This is usually communicated in advance. Depending on your check out and flight time return to New Marina (El Wataneya) port and disembark. Transfer to airport or hotel, disembark till 12:00 H (noontime) latest.

Important Info

You need to be at least an **Advanced Open Water certified diver and have 20 logged dives**. Advanced Open Water level is mandatory for wreck penetration dives and some of the more demanding sites visited on this safari, you must have dived in the last year and recorded this in your log book to join this safari, if needed a Scuba Review is available onboard.

The itinerary is an example so if you have a special wish for a certain place in this area just let your dive guide know. Liveaboard itineraries are subject to various unpredictable changes including weather conditions. All dives and especially some wreck dives are subject to divers experience and weather permitted. Live aboard itineraries depend on the Egyptian Government, Coast Guard and/or Marine Police approval. Every effort is made but we cannot guarantee diving at specific sites. The final decision lies with the captain and guide. Safety always comes first!